

Iron Man 3 is the culmination of a trilogy that started, for me, back in 2006. I was brought into the *Iron Man* art department to help out with characters and keyframes. As a comics fan, it was a dream come true: I was working on a character I loved, at a brand-new studio, for a director I loved working with. It was my first big movie, and I devoured every minute of it. From the late nights at Stan Winston with Phil Saunders and Adi Granov figuring out the Mark I—they did all the figuring on the Mark II and III—to the early mornings sketching the designs Tony was supposed to have done in the cave, it was pure joy. The camaraderie on that movie was something I will always cherish, fostered by the executives of Marvel, Jon Favreau, and Michael Riva.

Since most of the same crew came back for *Iron Man 2*, it was very easy to feel at home on that movie. The production started up pretty quickly after the first movie came out, so it basically felt like I never really left that world. We just jumped right back into designing new armors, new bad guys, and new moments for the film.

By the time *Iron Man 3* came around, my head was firmly planted in the Marvel Cinematic Universe. I loved Tony's Malibu mansion—I was there when it was first conceived, designed, and illustrated by Mike Riva and Phil Saunders—and I've stood in Tony's garage in three different locations in two states. On that set, it's always been a comfort to see the Mark I in the Hall of Armor and reminisce about the other movies. It's safe to say I probably have a nostalgic love for Tony Stark's tech and property as much as he does.

It is due to this wholehearted investment that I was the perfect audience member for this movie. Shane Black brilliantly used all of those emotional connections to punctuate Tony's journey throughout *Iron Man 3* in a manner that displayed his own love and respect for the character. As I began sifting through all the work that was done for this film and seeing where it all ended up, it occurred to me that I, too, had been on my own journey: an emotional journey within the Marvel Cinematic Universe—one that has given me a return that I would have never expected back in my cubicle in 2006. It has allowed me to value the nostalgia of where Tony has been, but also look to the future and all the places he could go. *Iron Man 3* is the end of one journey and the beginning to many more. I will be forever grateful to Shane Black, Kevin Feige, Louis D'Esposito, Victoria Alonso, Jon Favreau, and all the executives at Marvel for allowing me to participate in this wild ride one more time.



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